

Drift-Barrier Hypothesis: Short Note

This brief note discusses the drift-barrier hypothesis as it relates to the mutation-rate evolution literature. The Lynch (2011) lower-bound argument predicts an inverse relationship between per-site mutation rate and effective population size.

This claim is tracked in `cofr` as `claim_drift_barrier`. The Bergeron et al. (2023) vertebrate dataset supports it across primates and rodents, while Weinstein and Roy (2026) challenge the simple drift-barrier interpretation once life-history covariates are controlled for.

See `claim_drift_barrier` for tracked evidence.